



Problems in Auto apps

Researchers from Kaspersky Labs discover many security problems under the hood of connected car applications. <http://dgit.in/AutoSecure>



Hospital uses VR

A hospital in the UK has developed a virtual reality app for kids to watch that ease the nerves before an MRI. <http://dgit.in/VRmedUK>

Bazaar

MSI GE62 7RE Apache Pro

Blessed with the power of the 1050 Ti

MSI's lineup of gaming laptops covers a wide gamut when you think of how big the gaming segment is. The MSI range starts with the GL series and the hardware improves as you move up the line through the GP, GE, GS and lastly end up with the GT. We're looking at the MSI GE62 7RE Apache Pro which comes with the latest Kaby Lake processor on the 100-series platform.

Powered by an NVIDIA GTX 1050 Ti 4GB variant, this gaming laptop sits right in the middle of their spectrum offering users portability as well as good gaming performance.

Build

Simple upgrades like a little extra RAM or swapping out the MXM graphics card are what every gamer would look for in a gaming laptop. The MSI GE62 7RE does allow you to upgrade the hard drive, SSD and the RAM easily as is the case with any laptop (except Macs, they're just a pain to work with). However, the CPU and the GPU on the GE62 7RE aren't upgradeable as these are BGA SKUs which are soldered onto the motherboard.

There are plenty of heat pipes for cooling with certain sections of the heatpipes helping cool down MOSFETs aside from the CPU and the GPU which require the most cooling.

The display panel isn't too thick as is the case with most gaming laptops and we didn't notice any irregularities with the hinges. The entire thing opens up quite side to a good 140 degrees.

We prefer chiclet style keys for gaming and would pick anything that has a higher greater travel distance. The Steelseries keyboard on MSI gaming laptops aren't lacking. As for the TouchPad, we aren't fond of the brushed metal finish. There are quite a few standard gestures that Windows 10 supports like two finger swipes for scrolling which can be a little finicky to perform on this TouchPad. Vertical swiping is absolutely effortless but horizontal swiping has an unusual feel to it.

The matte finish barely throws any glare and the colours seems to be quite accurate. The brightness was a little lower than mainstream laptops that we've tested coming in at around 220 cd/m2. Tone response wasn't out of the ordinary but colour uniformity and colour accuracy were quite high.



Price
₹1,29,990

Overall, we'd say that the unit is pretty well designed and the lack of upgradeability is the only downside to the design.

Performance

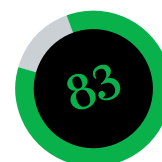
CineBench R15 scored 712 points in the CPU test and the laptop managed to crunch out 96.48 FPS in the OpenGL test. Even in PCMark, the GE62 7RE maintains a position in the top 1% of all the laptops we've tested with KabyLake CPUs.

We ran 3DMark Fire Strike a couple of times and averaged 7943 points. Unlike the GTX 1060, we don't get to see 60 FPS across all AAA titles. Instead, we're seeing more around the 40 FPS bracket. Rise of the Tomb Raider scored about 37.7 FPS, Witcher 3 with everything cranked up to max managed to scrape past with 25 FPS. At the end of the day, you will need to scale down a few of the parameters to get a smooth gameplay.

Verdict

The MSI GE62 7RE is a simple refresh with Intel's latest KabyLake processors. Priced at ₹1,29,990 and powered by a Core i7 7700HQ and NVIDIA GTX 1050 Ti, it offers quite the value proposition for gamers. The display is great, and for a gaming laptop, it only weighs 2.4 kg which isn't exactly light weight but we don't see any better alternatives at the moment. Slight compromises are needed to get playable frame-rates but if you're on the lookout for a gaming laptop with a good balance between gaming performance and portability, then the MSI GE62 7RE is a pretty good option.

Mithun Mohandas



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Specifications

Processor: Intel Core i7 7700HQ; **Platform:** HM175; **RAM:** 16 GB 2400 MHz; **Screen Size:** 15.6-inches; **Screen Resolution:** 1920x1080; **GPU:** 1050 Ti 4 GB; **SSD:** 128GB; **HDD:** HGST 1 TB; **Ethernet:** Killer E2500; **Battery:** 6-Cell 51 Whr; **AC Adapter:** 150 W; **Weight:** 2.4 Kg

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